

369ai

HR SUITE FOR ODOO 19

HR Field Attendance

Attendance from vehicle trips and customer visits, with GPS and trip totals

USER MANUAL

Module Version 19.0.1.0.0
Odoo 19 • Human Resources

Table of Contents

1. Introduction
2. Core Concepts
3. Navigating the Module
4. The Field Attendance Form
5. Setting Up the Primary Trip
6. Adding Additional Trips
7. Checking Out
8. Mobile App Integration
9. Troubleshooting & FAQ

1. Introduction

The HR Field Attendance module is built for employees who work in the field rather than at a fixed desk — sales representatives, delivery drivers and service staff. Instead of a simple check-in and check-out, their attendance for the day is built from the vehicle trips they made and the customer visits they logged.

Each field attendance record links to a primary trip and can hold any number of additional trips. The module captures GPS coordinates, derives the visited stops, and rolls up the day's distance, duration and fuel into a single Trip Totals view. The whole flow can be driven from the Odoo backend or from a mobile app through dedicated server calls.

1.1 Who Should Read This Manual

- **Field Employees** – understand how their day's trips and visits become an attendance record, and how to add or edit trips.
- **HR Officers / Managers** – review field attendance, check GPS and visited stops, and read the trip totals.
- **IT Administrators** – understand the dependencies and the mobile app integration points.

1.2 Key Capabilities

- A Field source flag that distinguishes field attendance from manual attendance.
- A primary Source Trip plus unlimited additional trips on one attendance day.
- GPS latitude and longitude captured from the trip or the first customer visit.
- An automatically derived list of visited stops.
- Trip Totals: total distance, duration, fuel litres and fuel amount across all trips.
- Guided popups for setting up the primary trip and adding additional trips.
- Automatic closing of the previous trip when a new one is added or on check-out.
- A dedicated Field Attendance menu, list view and search filters.
- Mobile-app server calls for inspecting and creating field attendance.

Module dependencies

HR Field Attendance builds on the standard Attendances (hr_attendance) and Employees (hr) apps, on the Attendance Late Tracking module, and on the Vehicle Tracking and Customer Visit modules. Late tracking continues to be handled by the Attendance Late Tracking module — this module focuses purely on the field side.

2. Core Concepts

2.1 The Building Blocks

Concept	Meaning
Attendance Source	Each attendance record is either Manual or Field. Field attendance records are the ones this module manages.
Trip	A vehicle journey recorded in the Vehicle Tracking module. It has a source, a destination, distance, duration and fuel data.
Customer Visit	A logged visit to a customer location, recorded in the Customer Visit module, with its own GPS coordinates.
Primary Trip	The main trip of the attendance day, stored directly on the attendance record as the Source Trip.
Additional Trip	Any further trip made on the same day, stored as a separate trip line under the same attendance.
Trip Totals	The sum of distance, duration and fuel across the primary trip and every additional trip.

2.2 How a Field Attendance Day Is Built

A field attendance day starts with a check-in and is then enriched with trips and visits. A typical day looks like this:

1. The employee checks in for the day. The attendance is marked as a Field source.
2. A primary trip is linked, either automatically from the day's first trip or by the employee through the Setup Primary Trip popup.
3. As the day continues, additional trips are added. Adding a new trip automatically closes the previous one.
4. Customer visits made during each trip are linked to that trip.
5. On check-out, the last open trip is closed and all linked visits are marked as done.

GPS priority

GPS coordinates are taken from the first customer visit where available, because that is where the employee physically stood with their phone. If no visit GPS is available, the trip's own start coordinates are used as a fallback. Manually entered coordinates are never overwritten.

2.3 Trip Lifecycle and Locking

A trip can be in progress or ended. Once a trip is ended it is locked: the trip itself and the parts of the attendance form that depend on it become read-only. This keeps a completed trip's

distance and fuel figures stable. Ended and cancelled trips are also hidden from the trip picker so they cannot be selected again.

3. Navigating the Module

The module adds a Field Attendance area in two places: under the Attendances app and as its own top-level application menu.

Menu	Purpose	Typical User
Field Attendance › All Field Attendance	Every field attendance record across the organisation.	HR Officer / Manager
Field Attendance › My Field Attendance	The current user's own field attendance records.	Field employee

The list view shows the attendance date, employee, source, GPS, the visited stops and the trip totals. Search filters let you focus on field-source records and group by employee or date.

4. The Field Attendance Form

Opening a field attendance record shows a Field Attendance section in addition to the standard attendance fields. This section appears only when the attendance source is Field.

4.1 The Primary Trip Card

The primary trip card shows the main trip of the day and its own metrics — not the day's totals. It displays:

- **Source Trip** – the linked primary trip.
- **Source and Destination Location** – where the trip started and ended.
- **GPS Latitude and Longitude** – the coordinates captured for the attendance.
- **KM Travelled and Duration** – the primary trip's own distance and time.

The card also provides action buttons:

- **Setup Primary Trip / Edit Primary Trip** – opens a focused popup to select the trip and link a visit.
- **Open Source Trip** – opens the full trip record in a dialog for detailed editing.
- **View Visits** – lists the customer visits linked to this attendance.

4.2 The Additional Trips Section

Below the primary trip card, the Additional Trips section lists every extra trip made on the same day. Each line behaves like a small version of the primary trip card, with its own source trip, visited stops, GPS and visits. The Add Additional Trips button starts the workflow described in Section 6.

4.3 The Trip Totals Section

At the bottom of the Field Attendance section, Trip Totals sums the figures across the primary trip and every additional trip:

Total	Meaning
Total KM Travelled	The combined distance of all trips on the day.
Total Duration	The combined driving time of all trips.
Total Fuel (Litres)	The combined fuel consumed across all trips.
Total Fuel Amount	The combined fuel cost across all trips.

Every trip line counts

Trip Totals adds each trip line separately. If the same vehicle or trip appears more than once, each occurrence still contributes to the totals — the figures are a true sum, not a deduplicated union.

5. Setting Up the Primary Trip

The primary trip can be linked automatically when the day starts, but it can also be set up or changed manually at any time through a focused popup.

5.1 Step by Step

6. Open the field attendance record.
7. **Click Setup Primary Trip** (or Edit Primary Trip if one is already linked).
8. **In the popup, choose the Source Trip.** Only trips not already used on another of this employee's attendances are listed, and ended or cancelled trips are hidden.
9. When you pick a trip, the GPS latitude, longitude and location are filled automatically from the trip if those fields are still empty.
10. **Add one visit** using the Add a line option in the Visits area, if you want to attach a customer visit.
11. Click Save.

A trip can only be used once

The trip picker excludes trips already linked to any of the employee's attendance records, including the current one. This guarantees the same trip is never counted twice across the employee's history.

6. Adding Additional Trips

When an employee makes more than one trip in a day, each additional trip is added as its own line. The module guides this as a short, two-part workflow so the previous trip is always properly closed first.

6.1 The Workflow

12. On the field attendance form, click Add Additional Trips.
13. **If the previous trip is still open**, the module first opens that trip in a popup with a banner asking you to enter the End KM and end the trip. Enter the End KM and click End Trip.
14. **The Add Additional Trip form then opens automatically.** Choose the Source Trip for the new trip and optionally link visits.
15. Click Save. The new trip line is added to the attendance.

If the previous trip was already closed, the module skips straight to the Add Additional Trip form.

Adding a trip closes the previous one

When a new trip line is saved, the module automatically ends the previous trip — the primary trip if this is the first additional line, or the previous additional trip otherwise — and marks any of its draft customer visits as done. This mirrors the real-world flow: starting a new trip means the last one is finished.

6.2 Editing and Deleting a Trip Line

- **Open Source Trip** – opens the underlying trip record for detailed editing.
- **View Visits** – lists the customer visits attached to that trip line.
- **Delete** – removes the trip line from the attendance and returns you to the attendance form.

Locked when ended

If the trip behind a trip line has been ended, that line becomes read-only on the attendance form. Ended trips are immutable to keep their distance and fuel figures reliable.

7. Checking Out

Checking out of a field attendance day does more than stamp the check-out time. The module finalises the day's field activity automatically.

When the check-out time is set on a field attendance record:

- **The last open trip is ended.** This is the most recent additional trip, or the primary trip if there are no additional trips. Earlier trips should already have been closed when the next one was added.
- **All linked customer visits are marked as done.** Every draft visit on the primary trip and on every trip line is moved to the done state.

This mirrors the mobile app

The same finalisation happens whether the check-out is done from the Odoo backend or from the mobile app's End Trip and Mark Attendance action, so the result is consistent across both.

8. Mobile App Integration

Field employees typically interact with this module through a mobile app rather than the Odoo backend. The module provides server calls that the app uses to inspect and create field attendance. This section is a reference for app developers and IT administrators.

8.1 Inspecting Today's Field Attendance

The app first asks the server about the employee's situation for the current day. The server responds with one of these statuses:

Status	Meaning
eligible	No attendance exists for today. The employee is ready to check in.
checked_in_open	A field attendance exists and the employee has not checked out yet.
checked_out	A field attendance exists and the employee has already checked out.
manual_exists	A non-field attendance already exists for today, so field attendance cannot be started.

8.2 Starting and Creating Field Attendance

The app can open a field attendance for the day with a check-in and no check-out, leaving the trip and visits to be picked later. It can also create a complete field attendance built from the day's trips and visits in one call.

Both operations apply the same safeguards:

- **Self-service only** – an employee can mark field attendance only for themselves. HR users can act for others.
- **One attendance per day** – the server refuses to create a second attendance if one already exists for the day, whether field or manual.
- **Trip and visit checks** – when building a complete record, the server requires an ended trip and at least one customer visit for the day.

For administrators

Because the server enforces eligibility and access on every call, the workflow stays correct even if the app's view of the situation is out of date. The server is always the source of truth.

9. Troubleshooting & FAQ

9.1 Common Questions

Question	Answer
A trip I want to use does not appear in the picker.	The trip is either already linked to another of the employee's attendance records, or it has been ended or cancelled. Used and closed trips are deliberately hidden so a trip is never counted twice.
I cannot edit a trip line on the attendance form.	The trip behind that line has been ended. Ended trips are locked to keep their distance and fuel figures stable.
The GPS on the attendance is from a visit, not the trip.	This is intended. The module prefers the first customer visit's coordinates because that is where the employee physically was. The trip's start coordinates are only a fallback.
I added a new trip and the previous one is now ended.	This is by design. Adding a new trip line automatically closes the previous trip and marks its draft visits as done.
The Field Attendance section is not visible.	The section appears only when the attendance source is Field. Manual attendance records do not show it.
The mobile app says I cannot start field attendance today.	A manual attendance, or an existing field attendance, already exists for today. Only one attendance per day is allowed.
Trip Totals look higher than expected.	Trip Totals sum every trip line separately. If a trip appears on more than one line, each occurrence is counted.

9.2 Good Practice Checklist

- Confirm the Vehicle Tracking and Customer Visit modules are installed and in use.
- Encourage employees to log customer visits as they happen, so GPS and visited stops are accurate.
- Add additional trips through the guided button so previous trips are closed correctly.
- Use check-out to finalise the day rather than leaving trips open.
- Review the Trip Totals when verifying distance and fuel claims.

End of manual — HR Field Attendance • 369ai HR Suite for Odoo 19